

PROJECT DEVELOPMENT PHASE

Salesforce CRM Application | Implementation Guide & Milestones

6. Project Development Phase

The development phase converts the planned CRM design into a working Salesforce application. Implementation is organized as a sequence of milestones, beginning with the developer environment and progressing through objects, navigation, configuration, automation, reporting and dashboards.

PROJECT FLOW

Milestone	Stage	Purpose
01	Developer Account	Create and activate the Salesforce development environment.
02	Object Creation	Create Employer, Customer and Enterprise custom objects.
03	Tabs	Create custom tabs for easy navigation.
04	Lightning App	Bring CRM operations together in a dedicated application.
05	Global Picklist	Standardize repeated values across CRM fields.
06	Fields & Relationships	Define the information captured and how records connect.
07	Page Layouts	Control which fields and sections users see.
08	Record Types	Support different customer or enterprise categories.
09	Validation Rules	Prevent inaccurate or incomplete data entry.
10	Email Templates	Prepare reusable customer communication templates.
11	Flows	Automate notifications, updates and business processes.
12	Reports & Dashboards	Turn CRM data into monitoring and analysis tools.
13	Conclusion	Review the completed CRM solution and outcomes.

What You'll Learn

1	Real-time Salesforce project workflow
2	Standard and custom objects
3	Picklist value sets
4	Types of fields and relationships
5	Page layouts
6	Record types
7	Validation rules
8	Email templates
9	Flows
10	Reports and dashboards

MILESTONE 1 • SALESFORCE DEVELOPER ACCOUNT

Activity 1: Creating Developer Account

Create a Salesforce Developer Org to provide the development environment for the CRM application.

Step	Action
1	Open the Salesforce Developer sign-up page.
2	Enter first name and last name.
3	Enter the email address used for account activation.
4	Set Role as Developer and enter the college/company name.
5	Select India as the country and enter the postal code.
6	Create a unique username using a name/organization-style format.
7	Submit the form using the sign-up option.

Activity 2: Account Activation

After registration, open the inbox associated with the sign-up email and use the verification message to activate the account.

Step	Action	Expected Result
01	Open the verification email.	Locate the Salesforce account-verification message.
02	Verify the account.	Select the verification link/button in the email.
03	Set credentials.	Create a password and answer the security question.
04	Open Salesforce.	Complete the password change and continue to the Salesforce setup environment.

Development Checkpoint

The developer environment is ready when the user can sign in successfully and access Salesforce Setup.

Implementation Note

The original project instructions specify that the activation email may take several minutes to arrive. The exact interface can vary as Salesforce updates its platform.

MILESTONE 2 • CUSTOM OBJECTS

All three objects follow the same Salesforce Object Manager workflow. Each object is configured to support reporting, activities, field-history tracking and search.

Object Label	Plural Label	Record Name	Data Type
Employer Account	Employer Accounts	Employer Account Name	Text
Customer Account	Customer Accounts	Customer Account Name	Text
Enterprise Account	Enterprise Accounts	Enterprise Account Name	Text

Common Configuration

Configuration	Details
Navigation	Setup → Object Manager → Create → Custom Object
Optional Features	Allow Reports • Allow Activities • Track Field History
Search	Allow Search
Completion	Save the custom object and repeat the process for the remaining objects.

MILESTONE 3 • CUSTOM TABS

Custom tabs provide direct navigation to the CRM objects from the Salesforce application.

Step	Implementation Action
1	Open Setup and search for Tabs in the Quick Find bar.
2	Open Tabs and select New under Custom Object Tabs.
3	Choose the Employer Accounts object and select a tab style.
4	Continue through profile/app settings using the project configuration.
5	Keep "Append tab to users' existing personal customizations" enabled and save.
6	Repeat the same process for Customer Accounts and Enterprise Accounts.

Build Result

At the end of these milestones, the CRM has its core data containers and direct navigation points ready for the next configuration stages.

MILESTONES 4–13 • CONFIGURATION TO ANALYTICS

The remaining milestones build the operational layer around the CRM data model. The sequence below keeps configuration dependencies clear.

No.	Milestone	Implementation Focus
04	Lightning App	Create a dedicated Lightning App that brings CRM operations together in one workspace.
05	Global Picklist	Create standardized reusable values for product type, category, status and similar fields.
06	Fields & Relationships	Add required fields and define relationships between relevant CRM records.
07	Page Layouts	Arrange fields and sections so users see the information relevant to each process.
08	Record Types	Create separate record types where different customer or enterprise categories need different processes.
09	Validation Rules	Validate phone numbers, PAN, Aadhaar and other required inputs to reduce incorrect entries.
10	Email Templates	Prepare reusable templates for birthdays, offers, order confirmations and other notifications.
11	Flows	Automate record updates, alerts, notifications and billing-related processes using Salesforce Flows.
12	Reports & Dashboards	Create reports and interactive dashboards for sales, customers and enterprise performance.
13	Conclusion	Review the completed solution, testing outcomes and overall project objectives.

CRM Implementation Architecture

PRESENTATION	APPLICATION	DATA	ANALYTICS
Lightning UI	Flows & Logic	Custom Objects	Reports & Dashboards

Development Outcome

The completed implementation brings together structured CRM data, controlled user access, consistent data entry, automated workflows, customer communication, and real-time business reporting within Salesforce.

Final Milestone Checklist

- ✓ Developer environment • ✓ Custom objects • ✓ Tabs & Lightning App • ✓ Fields & relationships
- ✓ Page layouts & record types • ✓ Validation • ✓ Email templates & flows • ✓ Reports & dashboards